

OWNED BRANDS SALES INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM

Board Decision Brief

Director, Owned Brands Sales (OB_Vend & OBCO) · June 19, 2026 · Status: Discovery / prototype

Turn competitor sell-through into higher-margin owned-brand revenue.

THE OPPORTUNITY

- Every OBCO customer buying a competitor part we cross to an owned brand is a margin-conversion opportunity — and today we can't see them.
- Owned Brands sells as a *vendor* inside a distributor. CORE and USD were built for the distributor; they don't show vendor-side sell-through, competitive conversion, or margin.
- The conversion pipeline lives in disconnected spreadsheets. No system tracks it.

THE SOLUTION

- A parallel, vendor-side sales-intelligence and CRM platform inside OBCO — read-only from governed OBCO data, owning only net-new Owned Brands activity.

THE VALUE LOOP — OUR NORTH STAR

Identify competitor sell-through → cross to an owned-brand equivalent → quantify the margin lift → equip the rep to convert

WHAT IT DOES

- SKU cross-reference engine — competitor part → owned-brand equivalent, living and searchable.
- Conversion targets ranked by margin upside, paired with a supply signal.
- Vendor-lens CRM — opportunities, quotes-in-progress, calls, demos, and engagements.
- AI email-drop (rep emails a note → structured records), datasheet cross-extraction, and a natural-language leadership dashboard.
- Inventory overlay with a pipeline-weighted demand forecast.

WHY THIS IS A LOW-RISK YES

- Read-only toward CORE and USD — no writes, no data duplication, no egress.
- Azure-native: Entra ID SSO, RBAC + row-level security, embedded certified Power BI, Azure OpenAI in-tenant.

THE ASK Approve read-only access to governed OBCO sales data (incl. margin/cost) for a defined Owned Brands user group, provision the Azure build environment, and assign governance liaisons. Tooling and budget detail overleaf.

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Owned Brands Sales Intelligence Platform — the case in one page

The prize: competitor sell-through is owned-brand revenue left on the table

Owned-brand product carries materially higher margin than the competitor lines our customers buy today. Each competitor part with an owned-brand cross is revenue we can move up the margin curve — if we can find it. Total addressable lift is [quantify with Data Office once sell-through access is granted].

Why our own systems can't see it — the vendor blind spot

CORE (ERP) and USD (CRM) serve the distributor operating model. Owned Brands operates as a vendor inside it and needs the lens those systems were never built to provide: brand sell-through, competitive conversion, margin, and the surrounding activity — opportunities, quotes, engagements. That gap is why the work lives in spreadsheets.

How it works — one loop, two tiers, one spine

- Two tiers: the **OBCO seller channel** (enablement) and **OBCO end customers** (demand). Owned-brand selling runs through the channel and into the customer.
- The SKU is the spine: one detail view unifies sales, stock, opportunities, crosses, and activity — no siloed dashboards.
- Scope of conversion targets is **all** OBCO customers — anyone buying competitor product is a target. Platform users are Owned Brands only.

Capabilities

Cross-reference engine	Competitor → owned-brand part mapping; living, searchable, AI-extracted from datasheets.
Conversion + supply	Targets ranked by margin upside; pipeline-weighted demand forecast surfaces a stock signal.
Vendor-lens CRM	Opportunities, quotes-in-progress, calls, visits, demos, hardware evals — for sellers and customers.
AI layer	Email-drop ingestion to structured records; natural-language leadership dashboard; in-tenant only.

Architecture & governance

- Hosting: Azure-native (App Service / Functions; Azure SQL for the isolated app database).
- Identity & access: Entra ID SSO, application RBAC, territory row-level security mirroring Power BI RLS — margin/cost confined to the authorized group.
- Reporting & AI: embedded certified Power BI (no dataset duplication); Azure OpenAI within the Microsoft boundary; sales and margin/cost handled as Confidential.

Risk boundaries — what we are NOT doing

No write/update/delete to CORE, USD, or any system of record · no direct production-DB connectivity · no duplication or ownership of OBCO data · no egress outside the Microsoft / Azure boundary.

Roadmap

Phase 0 — now	Scoping, prototype wireframe, access one-pager, systems discovery (in progress).
Phase 1	Secure read-only access approval; confirm mechanism with the Data Office.
Phase 2	Build production on Azure — data-access layer, app DB, identity, embedded Power BI.
Phase 3 → 4	AI layer (email-drop, datasheet crosses, NL query); rollout, education & sales-plan outputs.

The Ask

- **Read-only data access** — via governed datasets, certified Power BI, or the API layer: sales incl. margin/cost, open orders & backlog, quotes/bids, account/contact/SKU master, inventory. Sole user at launch: the Director, Owned Brands Sales (expandable).
- **Azure environment** — subscription/resource group under OBCO governance; Entra ID app registration; Azure OpenAI in-tenant; Power BI workspace + certified-dataset read access.
- **Governance liaisons** — named contacts from Data Office, BI Governance, Cloud Engineering, and IT Security; confirmation of the access workflow and margin/cost classification.
- **Developer tooling & hardware** — one MacBook Pro (or equivalent) as the primary dev workstation; standard dev licensing; incremental Azure consumption budget for the build phase, est. [confirm]/month during Phases 2–4.

Execution is solo — the Director builds and operates the platform; no additional headcount requested.